

The prophet Esay.

Wo be vnto them that ryse vp early to vse them selues in diontynges, and yet at night are more superfluous with wyne. In whose companies are harpes and lutes, tabrettes and pipes, and wyne. But they regard not the worke of the LORDE, and consider not the operaciō of his hondes. Therefore cometh my folck also in captiuyte, because they haue no vnderstandyng. Their glory shalbe myxt with hūger, and their pryde shalbe marred for thurst. Therefore gaperth hel, and openeth hyr mouth marvelous wyde: that pryde, boostinge and wisdom, with such as reioyse therein, maye descende in to it.

Thus shal man haue a fall, he shalbe brought lowe, and the high lokes of the proude layde downe. But the LORDE of hostes, y holy God: shalbe exalted and vntouched, when he shal declare his equityte and righteuousnesse after this maner. Then shal y lambs cate their apoynted feder, and shal fede plenteously in the mountaynes. Wo vnto vayne persones, that drawe wickednes vnto the, as it were with a corde: and synne, as it were with a cart rope. Which vse to speake on this maner: let h m make haist now, and go forth w his worke, that we maye se it. Let the counceyl of y holy one of y Israel come, and drawe me, y we maye knowe it.

Wo vnto them that call euil good, and good euil: which make darcknes light, and light darcknesse, y make sower swete, and swete sower. Wo vnto them that are wise in their owne sight, and thinke them selues to haue vnderstandyng. Wo vnto them, y are counyngte men to suppe out wyne, and experte to set vp dycknesse. These gyue sentence with the vngodly for rewardes, but condemne the iust cause of the righteuous.

Therefore, like as fyre licketh vp the strawe, and as the flame cōsumeth the stubble: Euen so (when their root is ful) their blossom shal vanishe awaye like dust or smoke for they despyse the lawe of the LORDE of hostes, and blasphemie the worde of the holy maker of y Israel.

Therefore is the wrath of the LORDE kindled also agaynst his people, and he shal keth his honde at them: yee he shal smyte so, that the hilles shal tremble. And their carcasses shal lye in the open stretes, like myre. After all this, the wrath of God shal not cease, but he shal stretch his hōde wyder. And he shal gyue a tokē vnto a straunge people, and call vnto them in a farr

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countrie: and beholde, they shal come hastily with spede. There is not one saynt nor feble amonge them, no not a slogisly nor sleepy parson. There shal not one of them put of the gyrdle from his loynes, ner lose the lacher of his shue. Their arrows are sharpe, and their bowes bent. Their horse hoes are like flynt, and their cartwheles like a stormy wynde. Their crie is as it were of a lyon, and the roaringe of them like lyons helpes. They shal roare, and hatch vp the praye, and no man shal recover it or get it from the. In that daye they shal be so scarce vpon them, as the see. And yee like vnto the londe, beholde, it shalbe all darcknesse and sorowe. Yf we loke to he anen: beholde, it shalbe darck with careful desperation.

The vii Chapter.

In the same yere y Kyng of Syas dyed, y Iane the LORDE sittynge vpon an high and gloriouse seate, and his trayne fylled y palace. From aboue flakred the Seraphims, a herof every one had sex wynges. With twayne ech couered his face, w twayne his fete, and with twayne dyd he flye. They cried also ech one to other on this maner: holy, holy, holy is the LORDE of hostes. The whole worlde is ful of his glory. See the geastes and dorechekes moued at the criege, and the horse was ful of smoke. Then I sayde: Who is me. For I nas astonished: that I (which am a man of vncleynnes, and dwell amonge people y hath vncleynnes also: Shulde y Kyng and LORDE of hostes with my ne eyes.

Then fiewe one of the Seraphims vnto me, hauinge a hote cole in his honde, a hich he had taken from the altier with the tonges, and touched my mouth, and sayde: lo, this hath touched thy mouth, and thy vngodlynes is taken awaye, and thy synne forgiven. After this I herde the voyce of the LORDE takinge aduysment on this maner: Whem shal I sende, and who wilke cure messanger? The I sayde: here am I, sende me. And so he sayde: go, and tel this people: ye shall heare in deede, but ye shal not vnderstande, ye shal plainly see, and not perceaue. Hard en the hartes of this people, stoppe their eares, and shut their eyes, that they se not w their eyes, heare not with their eares, and vnderstande not with their hartes, and conuerte and be healed.

Then spake I: LORDE, how longe shall

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swere: vntil the cities be utterly without inhabitours, and y houses without men, till the lōde be also desolate, and lye vnbuylded. For the LORDE shal take the men far awaye, so that the londe shal lye waiste. Nevertheless, the tenth parte shal remayne therein, for it shal conuerte and be fructifull. And likewise as the Terebintes and Okerrees bunge forth their frutes, so shal the holy fede haue frute.

The seuenth Chapter.

It happened in the tyme of Ahas the sonne of Ionathas, which was the sonne of Joathan Kyng of Juda: that Rezin the Kyng of Siria, and Poca Rome lies sonne, Kyng of y Israel: wente vp to ward Jerusalem to beseye it (but wame it not). Now when the house of Dauid (that is Ahas) herde worde therof, y Siria and Ephraim were confederate together: his herrequated (yee and y herres also of his people) like as a tre in the felde, that is moued with the wynde.

Then sayde God vnto Esay: go mete Ahas (thou and thy sonne Sear Jasub) at the heade of y ouer pole, in the fore path by the fullers grounde, and saye vnto him: take hede to thyself and be still, but feare not, nether be saynt harted, for these two tales: that is: for these two smokynge fyre brandes, the wrath and furiousnes of Rezin the Sirian and Rome lies sonne: because that the Kyng of Siria Ephraim and Rome lies sonne haue wickedly conspyred agaynst the, sayenge: We will go downe in to Juda, vnto the, and brynge them vnder vs, and set a Kyng there. euen the sonne of Taball. For thus saith the LORDE God thereto, It shall not so go forth, nether come so to passe: for the head citie of y Sirians is Damascus, but the head of Damascus is Rezin. And after fyue and threescore yere, shal Ephraim be nomore a people. And the chiefe citie of Ephraim is Samaria, but the head of Samaria is Rome lies sonne. And yf ye beleue not, there shall no promyse be kepte with you.

Moreover, God spake vnto Ahas, sayenge: requyre a token of the LORDE thy God, whether it be towarde the depty beneath or towarde y hight aboue. The sayde Ahas: I will requyre none, nether will I tempte the LORDE. The LORDE answered: Then heare to, ye of the house of Dauid: Is it not ynough for you, that ye be greuous vnto men, but ye must greue my God also? And therefore the LORDE shal geue you a token

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of himself: Beholde, a virgin shal cōceiue and beare a sonne, and shal call his name Emanuel. But ter and hony shal he eate, y he maye knowe the enel, and chose y good. But ouer that childe come to knowlege, releschue the enel and chose the good: The londe (that thou art so afraide for) shalbe deplorate of both hir kynges.

The LORDE also shal sende a tyme vpon the, vpon thy people, and vnto thy fathers house (such as neuer came sence the tyme y Ephraim departed from Juda) thore w y Kyng of the Assirians. For at the same tyme shal the LORDE whyle for the flyes y are aboute the water of y Egipte, and for y Beyes in the Assirians londe. These shall come, and shal light all in the valeyes, in y vountes of stone, vpon all grene thynges, and in all corners.

At the same tyme shal the LORDE shene the hayre of the heade and the fete and the beard cleue of, with the rasoure that he shal paye them withall beyonde the water: namely, with y Kyng of the Assirians. At the same tyme shal a man lye with a corwe, and two shepe. Then because of the aboundaunce of mylk, he shal make butter and eat it. So that every one which remaineth in the londe, shal eate butter and hony. At the same tyme all vynyardes (though there be a thousand vynes in one, and were solde for a thousand siluer linges) shalbe turned to briers and thornes. Like as they shal come in to the londe with arrows and bowes, so shal all the londe become briers and thornes. And as for all hilles that now are hewen downe, thou shalt not come vnto them, for feare of briers and thornes. But the catel shal be dryuen thither, and the shepe shal fede there.

The viii Chapter.

Where the LORDE sayde vnto me: Take the a greate leaf, and wyte in it, as men do with a penne, that he spede him to robbe, and haist him to spoyle. And Immediately I called vnto me faithful wytnesses: Oias the prest, and Zacharias y sonne of Barachias. After that went I vnto the prophetisse, that now had conceiued and borne a sonne. Then sayde the LORDE to me: geue him this name: Maher schal hafchbas, that is: a speedier robber, an hastie spoyle. For why, ouer the childe shal haue knowlege to saye: Abi and Im, y is father, and mother: shal y riches of Damascus and y substance of Samaria be take awaye, thore w the Kyng of y Assirians.

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Luc. 1 d
Math. 1 d

2. Par. 32 a
Esa. 36 a

2. Par. 32 e

Esa. 30 b

4. Re. 16 b
4. Re. 17 a